

Staff Setup, Prep, and Safety Checklist

Work top to bottom. The core rule: bins packed before instruction, score sheets before testing, PPE before materials.

FOUR WEEKS BEFORE

- ☐ Confirm camp roster, team count, and the full allergy roster.
- ☐ Confirm all materials are ordered and on track to arrive before camp.
- ☐ Confirm Ambler greenhouse, pool, arboretum, and ropes-course access; Engineering and BookBot hosts; transportation; and the timing in the live schedule.
- ☐ Confirm Minecraft Education access or prepare the paper-grid fallback.

ONE WEEK BEFORE

- ☐ Pack and label one bin per activity. Mark reusable versus consumable.
- ☐ Print student handout packets, instructor guides, score sheets, station signs, and the reward kit.
- ☐ Pre-build any instructor demo pieces (Mud Battery reference cell, sample clinometer, sample cam).
- ☐ Test all devices: microscopes, multimeters, microcontrollers or Minecraft devices if used.

DAY BEFORE EACH CAMP

- ☐ Lay out station signs and confirm the room flow.
- ☐ Stage PPE: goggles, nitrile gloves, trays, handwashing supplies.
- ☐ Stage leakproof trays and fresh trash-bag or table liners for Mud Battery, Xylem Pipeline, and Photosynthesis stations.
- ☐ Pre-moisten Mud Battery soil; prepare baking-soda and oobleck mixes only as needed.
- ☐ Load slide decks and confirm the projector and timer work.

DAILY MORNING

- ☐ Bins packed and at stations before students arrive.
- ☐ Score sheets ready before any testing starts.
- ☐ PPE visible and distributed before materials are handed out.
- ☐ Review the day's specific safety notes with all staff.

DAILY AFTERNOON RESET

- ☐ Collect score slips and update the leaderboard.
- ☐ Return reusable items to bins; dispose of consumables; wipe surfaces.
- ☐ Cover and store any weeklong items (Mud Battery cells).
- ☐ Restock PPE and consumables for the next day.

ACTIVITY-SPECIFIC SAFETY FLAGS

- ☐ Mud Battery: gloves, no food at the station, wash hands, cells sealed except during checks.
- ☐ Magnetic Capsule Maze: magnets counted in and out; keep away from devices.
- ☐ Oobleck and water activities: trays down, floors dry, no eating.
- ☐ Pinhole optics: never view the sun directly.
- ☐ Hovercraft: only staff operate low-temperature hot glue; let glue cool before campers handle the puck.
- ☐ Field trips: host rules override camp rules; buddy system and hydration outdoors.